H-B-71b
January 2, 1964

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. H-B-00656, March 18, 1960,
Emergency Fed. Spec. H-B-071a, August 10, 1951, and
Fed. Spec. H-B-71a, September 23, 1943.

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BROOM, PUSH, VEGETABLE FIBER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers push brooms made of vegetable fiber such as rattan and used primarily for the sweeping of streets or other similar hard-surface areas.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types.* Push brooms covered by this specification shall be furnished in the following types, as specified:

Type I.—Without handle.
Type II.—With handle.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

QQ-S-781—Steel Strapping, Flat.
PPP-T-97 — Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (For Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-W-6110—Wood, Determination of Moisture Content of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130—Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Standard sample.** When a standard sample is used by a Government agency in procurement, brooms offered for delivery shall equal that sample in workmanship and balance, stiffness, solidity, kind, and quality of fiber, and in any other respects not specifically covered in this specification.

3.2 **Material.**

3.2.1 *Vegetable fiber.* The fiber shall be No. 4 round rattan fiber approximately 1/8 inch in diameter or suitable size and quality of palm fiber, palmyra stalks, bass fiber, or a mixture thereof.

3.2.2 *Block.* The wood block shall be elm, ash, beech, birch, maple, Sitka spruce, or Southern gum, free from all defects and dried to not less than 8 percent or more than 12 percent moisture content at time of fabrication when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.2.3 *Handle, type II.* The handle shall be made of close- and straight-grained hardwood and shall be free from defects which might impair its serviceability.

3.2.4 *Wire.* The wire used for staple setting the fiber in the holes shall be made of corrosion resisting metal or metal made corrosion resisting by a suitable plating. The diameter of the wire shall be not less than 0.0475 inch.

3.3 **Design.** The broom shall be of the general design shown in figure 1.

3.4 **Construction.**

3.4.1 *Block.* The wood block 3.2.2, shall be smoothly finished and each end coated with varnish, lacquer, or other transparent organic coating to prevent penetration of moisture. The block shall have two holes for the handle, one on each side, equidistant from the ends of the block. The dimensions of the block. and the number of holes required for the fiber shall be as specified in table I.

3.4.1.1 *Holes for fiber.* The holes for the fiber shall be arranged so as to distribute the fiber uniformly over the entire face of the block. The holes shall have a head slant of approximately 15 degrees and/or a side slant of approximately 9 degrees and 3 degrees. The holes shall be completely filled with the fiber specified in 3.2.1 and the fiber securely staple set.

3.4.1.2 *Holes for handle.* The holes for the handle shall be at an angle of 45 degrees and shall be tapered in the same ratio as the block end of the handle to firmly engage the handle, 3.4.2.

3.4.2 *Handle.* The handle for type II brooms shall be wood, 3.2.3, smoothly finished, rounded at the hand end, and tapered at the block end to 3/4-inch diameter in a length of 3 inches from the end.

3.5 **Dimensional requirements.** The broom shall conform to the dimensional requirements in table I.

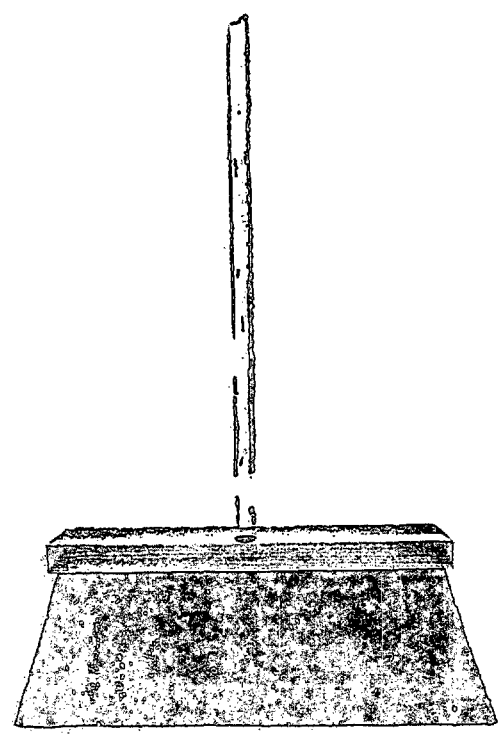


FIGURE 1.—Broom, Push, Vegetable Fiber

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TABLE I.—*Dimensional requirements of broom*

Block:	
Length, minimum, inches	16
Width, minimum, inches	3-1/2
Thickness, minimum, inches	1-3/8
Holes for fiber:	
Total number, minimum	58
Number in each side row, minimum	14
Number at each end, minimum	5
Depth, minimum, inch	5/8
Holes for handle, number	2
Fiber:	
Length clear of block, minimum, inches	6-3/4
Weight per brush, minimum, ounces	24-1/2
Handles, type II:	
Length, minimum, inches	54
Diameter, minimum inches	1-1/8

3.6 Marking. Each broom shall be marked with the contractor's name or trademark and the Federal stock number. In addition, marking for the military shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-130, when required.

3.7 Workmanship. The brooms shall be free from defects which might affect their serviceability or appearance.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Inspection responsibility. Unless otherwise specified, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 *Lot.* All brooms of the same type presented at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of inspection and tests.

4.2.2 *Sampling for inspection.* Unless otherwise specified in the invitation to bid, a random sample of brooms shall be taken for inspection from each lot of brooms in accordance with table II.

TABLE II.—*Sampling for inspection*

Number of brooms in lot	Number of brooms in sample	Acceptance number (defectives)	Rejection number (defectives)
65 and under	7	0	1
66 to 180	25	1	2
181 to 300	35	2	3
301 to 500	50	3	4
501 to 800	75	4	5
801 to 1,300	110	6	7
1,301 and over	150	8	9

4.2.3 *Sampling for test.* Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, a random sample of brooms shall be taken for test from each lot of brooms in accordance with table III.

TABLE III.—*Sampling for tests*

Number of brooms in lot	Number of brooms in sample	Acceptance number (nonconforming)	Rejection number (nonconforming)
180 and under	2	0	1
181 to 500	3	0	1
501 to 1,300	5	0	1
1,301 to 3,200	7	0	1
3,201 to 8,000	10	0	1
8,001 and over	15	1	2

4.3 Inspection. Each broom in the sample for inspection, 4.2.2, shall be inspected for type, design, marking, workmanship, construction, width and length of block, length and diameter of handle, length of fiber out of block, number of holes in each side row and at each end, smoothness of block, coating on ends of block and smoothness of handle. When a standard sample is used by a Government agency, the broom shall be compared with the sample as described in 3.1.

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4.3.1 *Width of block.* The width of the block shall be measured from edge to edge of the face of the block at three places and shall include any beveling. If the block has curved ends, none of the measurements shall be made less than one inch from the curved ends.

4.4 Tests. Each broom in the sample for test, 4.2.3, shall be tested for total number of holes in block, depth of holes in block and weight of vegetable fiber in broom, 4.4.1.

4.4.1 *Weight of fiber.* The fiber shall be removed from the broom, conditioned for not less than 16 hours in air at a relative humidity of 50 ± 4 percent and at a temperature of 23° ± 1.1° C. (73.4° ± 2.0°F.), and weighed in that atmosphere to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4.4.2 *Thickness of block.* The thickness shall be measured along the lengthwise center line of the block at not less than three places between the ends. If the block has curved ends, none of the thickness measurements shall be made less than one inch from the curved ends.

4.4.3 *Test for moisture content of wood.* Wood for the block shall be tested for moisture content in accordance with any method specified in MIL-W-6110 to determine compliance with any method specified in MIL-W-6110 to determine compliance with 3.2.2.

4.4.4 *Identification of fiber.* A certificate of compliance will be required to be submitted by the contractor stating the fiber contained in brooms delivered in accordance with paragraph 3.2.1 of this specification.

4.5 Compliance criteria.

4.5.1 *Inspection.* Any broom in the sample for inspection failing to conform to the requirements for which the inspection was made, 4.3, shall be considered defective. If the number of defective brooms in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample specified in table II, the entire lot of brooms from which the sample was taken shall be considered to have failed to meet the requirements of this specification.

4.5.2 *Tests.* Any broom in the sample for tests failing to conform to the requirements for which tests were made, 4.4, shall be considered defective. If the number of defective brooms in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample specified in table III, the entire lot of brooms from which the sample was taken shall be considered to have failed to meet the requirements of this specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Fed. Std. No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing protection for civil agency procurements.)

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Brooms shall be packed in (overseas type) fiber boxes conforming to class 2 of PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s and closed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Handles shall be strapped in bundles with corrugated fiberboard or other overwrap. Filament reinforced pressure-sensitive tape conforming to PPP-T-97 may be utilized in lieu of steel strapping conforming to QQ-S-781.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Broom blocks shall be packed 6 to a box in (domestic type) fiber boxes conforming to class 1 of PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Unless otherwise specified 12 handles shall be formed into a compact bundle with all ends even, and secured. These bundles (36 handles) shall then be completely wrapped in burlap, osnaburg, or similar material (cloth) and the ends folded. The complete wrapping shall be secured by stitching ends and side seams with strong cotton twine. Alternately, 36 handles (3 handles)

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may be completely wrapped with at least two thicknesses of 50/30 pound kraft paper; ends shall be neatly folded and secured by taping with 50/60 pound gummed kraft tape. Side seam of wrap shall be securely taped or secured with a suitable adhesive.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Brooms and handles shall be packed in a manner to insure safe delivery and acceptance at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking for shipment shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type of broom (see 1.2).
(*c*) Marking in accordance with MIL-STD-130 when required (see 3.6).
(*d*) Level of packing (see 5.1).

6.2 Level B. Packing should be used by ordering agencies only when shipment is known to be made to a holding supply depot or warehouse from which partial shipments will be made to ultimate consumers.

6.3 Transportation description. The transportation description and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Brooms, vegetable fiber.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Brooms, vegetable fiber.
Truckload minimum weight (w) 24.4 pounds, (W) subject to Rule 115 National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—QMC

Navy—S&A

Air Force—MOA

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)*

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.

QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED

DOLLAR AMOUNT
$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 APR 63 1426 REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE PLATE NO. 15419

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